

Marc Andressen: "Technology is quite literally the lever for being able to take natural resources and able to make something better out of them."

Read Bain: "technology includes all tools, machines, utensils, weapons, instruments, housing, clothing, communicating and transporting devices and the skills by which we produce and use them."

Ian Barbour: "Technology may be defined as the application of organized knowledge to practical tasks by ordered systems of people and machines."

C.L. Bush: "Technology is a form of human cultural activity that applies the principles of science and mechanics to the solution of problems. It includes the resources, tools, processes, personnel, and systems developed to perform tasks and create immediate particular, and personal and/or competitive advantages in a given ecological, economic, and social context."

Martin van Creveld: "Technology is perhaps best understood as an abstract system of knowledge, an attitude towards life and a method for solving its problems."

Jacques Ellul: "The totality of methods rationally arrived at and having absolute efficiency (for a given state of development) in every field of human activity."

Frederick Ferré: "Practical implementations of intelligence" (with the caveat that 'practical' requires that they *not be wholly ends in themselves*; 'implementations' entails that a technology be somehow *concretely embodied* in artefacts or practices).

John Fernald: "The ability to convert society's resources (labor and capital) into output (goods and services that we value)."

Robert Friedel #1: "The knowledge and instruments that humans use to accomplish the purposes of life," *excluding "processes that are completely mental or biological, knowledge of the world that is purely in the realm of ideas, description, or nature"* (exceptions paraphrased).

Robert Friedel #2: "Technology can, indeed, be defined as a pursuit of power over nature."

John Kenneth Galbraith: "Technology means the systematic application of scientific or other organized knowledge to practical tasks."

Thomas P. Hughes #1: "A creativity process involving human ingenuity."

Thomas P. Hughes #2: "The *effort* to organize the world for problem solving so that goods and services can be invented, developed, produced, and used."

Thomas P. Hughes #3: "Problem-solving systems ... concerned with the reordering of the material world."

David M. Kaplan: "Systems that combine technique and activities with implements and artifacts, within a social context of organization in which the technologies are developed, employed, and administered."

Immanuel Kant: "Man's rational and ordered attempt to control his natural environment."

Kranzberg & Purcell: "Technology is much more than tools and artifacts, machines and processes. It deals with man's attempts to satisfy his wants by human action on physical objects."

Edwin Mansfield: "Society's pool of knowledge regarding the industrial arts. It consists of knowledge used by industry regarding the principles of physical and social phenomena... knowledge regarding the application of these principles to production... and knowledge regarding the day-to-day operations of production..."

J.B. McOmber: "Technology as Instrumentality: what makes something a technology is simply its status as a tool."

Emmanuel Mesthene: "The organization of knowledge for the achievement of practical purposes."

Joel Mokyr: "Any change in the application of information to the production process in such a way as to increase efficiency, resulting either in the production of a given output with fewer resources (i.e., lower costs), or the production of better or new products."

Paul Nightingale: "Technologies are entities produced by a problem solving process that changes and transforms the world so that it matches a preconceived idea, or plan, or design to generate a desired artificial function."

Richard Rhodes: "Technology is the application of science, engineering and industrial organization to create a human-built world."

Charles Singer: "How things are commonly done or made and what things are done or made."

Bernard Stiegler: "The pursuit of life by means other than life."

Peter Thiel: "Properly understood, any new and better way of doing things is technology."

Christian Wolff: "Technology is the science of skills and works of skill, or, if one prefers, the science of things made by man's labour, chiefly through the use of his hands."

